

SATNAM SINGH GANDHI, 33

Bangalore

INVESTING IN STOCKS SINCE 2006

INITIAL INVESTMENT Rs 1 lakh

CURRENT PORTFOLIO VALUE Rs 5 lakh

WHAT I DO WHEN MARKET FALLS I get more cautious but I still have not made an exit.

WHAT I LEARNT Investing requires patience and risk-taking ability. There are gains to be made in times like these when the markets are going up like never before.

I have spread my investment across funds and stocks. I have booked profits more than once.

then laughing all the way to the bank.

Yes, that's exactly what many investors have done. They are the ones who smile when the pink papers sport black borders and mournfully announce that the Sensex has crashed to a two-month low. *Money Today* spoke to several such investors across the country, who hold portfolios ranging from a few tens of thousands of rupees to several lakhs. What unites them is the fact that volatile markets hold little fear for them. Most of them started off by investing small amounts. As their profits grew, so did their confidence. With that, their knowledge. Many of the investors say they started tracking their investments only after they started showing some returns. Today, they can discuss investing with the best in the business.

If they could do it, there's nothing to stop you, is there? At the risk of being boring, let us reiterate the fact that the best strategy when investing in volatile markets should be based on

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your financial needs, investment goals and attitudes toward risk. No investment strategy, however, can guarantee a profit or protection against loss. So, keep a long-term perspective and avoid investing emotionally.

Learning investment and stock market strategies is not as difficult as it seems. All the investors we spoke to will tell you this. The thing to do is to make the markets a part of your everyday life. Don't let the doom-sayers stop you from entering the market. As we show you, there's a lot to smile about.

START SMALL BUT DO NOT STOP THERE

Start off small, and as you get more comfortable with the markets, begin consolidating your gains. You might get impatient, since you're hardly likely to see a portfolio worth lakhs come out overnight from an investment of a few thousand rupees. But remember that line you were taught in school—little drops of water make a mighty ocean.

The advantage with starting small is that even a crash that wipes out your portfolio will not have an impact

